

Calm & Oak

THE PREMIUM PACK

# The Japandi *Styling Pack*

*The styling formulas — shelves, surfaces, light,  
and the 30-day plan to a calmer home.*



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# Styling is a *system*, not a gift.

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*A calm room isn't styled by instinct. It's a handful of repeatable formulas — for the shelf, the surface, the wall, the light — applied with discipline.*

The free cheat-sheet gives you the colours. This pack gives you the **moves**: how to arrange a shelf so it reads calm, how many objects belong on a surface, how to hang and pair prints, how to light a room so it feels warm at night — and a 30-day plan that turns the whole thing into a habit.

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# Five styling *principles.*

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*i*

## Negative space is the object

In Japandi, the empty space (*ma*) is as composed as the things. Leave more bare surface than feels comfortable — the calm lives in the gaps. A styled surface is two-thirds empty.

*ii*

## Odd numbers, varied heights

Group in threes (or ones), never even rows. Vary the height of every cluster — tall, medium, low — so the eye travels. Three objects at the same height read as a line-up; staggered, they read as a still life.

*iii*

## Repeat the material, not the object

Calm comes from a room saying one thing in many places — stoneware here and there, linen in three weights, wood in two tones. Repetition of material reads intentional; variety of object reads cluttered.

*iv*

## One thing should be alive

A single plant, branch, or stem per zone. It's the one element allowed to be irregular, and it keeps a disciplined room from feeling clinical. One — not a jungle.

*v*

## Style at eye level, then sit down

Arrange standing, then sit where you actually live and look again. Most rooms are styled for a photo and lived in from a sofa. Calm is what you see from the chair, not the doorway.

COPY THESE

# Shelf & surface *formulas.*

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## The open shelf (*per shelf*)

1. **One tall vertical** — a vase, a stacked pair of books on end, a tall jug.
2. **One horizontal stack** — 2–4 books lying flat, tonal spines out or pages out.
3. **One small object** on the stack — a ceramic dish, a stone, a small bowl.
4. **One-third of the shelf left empty.** Always. The gap is the styling.

## The coffee table (*four moves*)

1. **A tray** to define the zone — wood or stoneware.
2. **One stack of two books**, a small object resting on top.
3. **One organic element** — a low bowl, a single stem, a stone.
4. **Bare wood** for the rest. Never fill the table.

## The console / sideboard (*symmetry + one break*)

1. **A lamp or large vessel** to one side — the tall anchor.
2. **A framed print or mirror** leaning behind, slightly off-centre.
3. **One low cluster of three** at varied heights on the other side.
4. **A clear centre.** Weight the ends, leave the middle open.

# The three-weight *rule.*

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Japandi rooms stay nearly monochrome, so **texture does the work colour does elsewhere**. The rule: in any zone, layer the same neutral at three different weights and you get depth without a second colour.

## Three weights, one neutral

1. **Fine** — a smooth weave: linen sheeting, a flat-woven runner, a paper shade.
2. **Mid** — a visible weave: a wool throw, a slubby linen cushion, a jute mat.
3. **Coarse** — a chunky texture: a knitted blanket, a boucle cushion, a rough basket.

Apply it to the sofa (cushion, throw, rug), the bed (sheet, duvet, blanket), the reading chair (seat, throw, floor). Three weights of oat reads richer than five colours of cushion — and it never dates.

### *The test*

Photograph the zone in black and white. If it still reads as layered and warm with no colour, the texture is doing its job. If it goes flat, add a coarser weight — not another colour.

# Hanging & pairing *prints.*

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## Where it hangs

1. **Centre at 57–60 inches** from the floor — gallery height, the eye's natural line.
2. **Above furniture:** the art spans about two-thirds of the piece below it, with a hand's-width of breathing room above the back of the sofa or bed.
3. **Lean, don't hang,** on a console or shelf for a softer, less permanent calm.

## Pairing the Calm & Oak prints

1. **One statement, or a quiet pair** — a single ensō, or two botanicals in matching frames. Avoid the busy grid.
2. **Match the print to the room's accent** — sumi-e ink for charcoal & cream; botanical line for stone & sage; a tonal study for warm-grey monochrome; a terracotta-toned landscape for the accent palette.
3. **Frame in the room's lead wood** — oak frames in an oak room, walnut in a walnut room. Thin profiles, wide mats.

### *The pairing shortcut*

A diptych of two prints from the same Calm & Oak series (two moons, two botanicals, two tonal studies) is the safest wall in Japandi — related, restrained, never busy. Browse the series at [calmandoak.com/shop/prints](https://calmandoak.com/shop/prints).

# Lighting for *calm*.

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A room can be perfectly styled and still feel cold the moment the overhead light comes on. Calm lighting follows three rules.

*i*

## Warm, always — 2700K

Every bulb in a calm room is warm white (2700K), never cool or daylight (4000K+). One cool bulb in a lamp throws off the whole room's temperature. Check the box; "soft white" is usually right, "bright white" is not.

*ii*

## Low and layered, not overhead

Switch off the ceiling light at night and light the room in pools — a floor lamp, a table lamp, a paper lantern. Three low warm sources read calm; one bright overhead reads like an office.

*iii*

## One soft glow per zone

Every place you sit or work gets one warm light within reach. A paper or linen shade diffuses it; bare bulbs and glossy shades glare. Dimmers turn a good room into a calm one — add them where you can.

### *The evening test*

At night, turn off the overhead and switch on only the lamps. If the room feels warm and you don't reach for the ceiling switch, the lighting is right.

BEFORE YOU COMMIT

# The ten styling *mistakes.*

## DO

Leave two-thirds of every surface bare.

Group in odd numbers at varied heights.

Repeat one material across the room.

Layer three weights of one neutral.

Use warm 2700K light, low and layered.

Keep one living element per zone.

Hang art at 57–60 inches, centred.

Conceal clutter in baskets and closed storage.

Style standing, then check from the chair.

Stop one piece earlier than feels finished.

## DON'T

Fill a shelf or surface edge to edge.

Line objects up at one height.

Mix many small unrelated decorative objects.

Add a second colour to fix a flat room.

Rely on the cool overhead light at night.

Crowd a corner with several plants.

Hang art too high, floating above the sofa.

Leave cables, remotes and chargers on show.

Style only for the doorway photo.

Keep adding "one more" piece.

### *The one that fixes most rooms*

Remove a quarter of what's on display and put it away for a month. Nine rooms in ten read calmer immediately — Japandi is mostly the discipline of taking away.



TURN IT INTO A HABIT

# The 30-day calm-home *plan.*

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One small move a day. No room torn apart, no big spend — just a daily edit that compounds into a calmer home by week four.

## *Week 1 · Clear*

- ☐ **Day 1–2:** Clear every flat surface in one room completely. Live with it bare for a day.
- ☐ **Day 3–4:** Return only what earns its place — a third of what was there.
- ☐ **Day 5–6:** Box up the rest; store it out of sight for the month.
- ☐ **Day 7:** Hide the cables, remotes and chargers in that room.

## *Week 2 · Warm*

- ☐ **Day 8–9:** Replace every cool bulb in the room with 2700K warm white.
- ☐ **Day 10–11:** Add or reposition one low lamp; switch off the overhead at night.
- ☐ **Day 12–13:** Layer three weights of one neutral on the main seat or bed.
- ☐ **Day 14:** Sit where you live and re-style from there.

### *Week 3 · Compose*

- ☐ **Day 15–16:** Style one shelf with the shelf formula — tall, stack, small, gap.
- ☐ **Day 17–18:** Style the coffee table or console with its formula.
- ☐ **Day 19–20:** Hang or lean one print at 57–60 inches; frame in the room's wood.
- ☐ **Day 21:** Add one living element — a stem, a branch, one plant.

### *Week 4 · Repeat & refine*

- ☐ **Day 22–24:** Carry the same three moves into a second room.
- ☐ **Day 25–26:** Walk the home; remove anything that breaks the one-material rule.
- ☐ **Day 27–28:** Do the black-and-white photo test on two rooms; add texture, not colour.
- ☐ **Day 29:** The evening light test — lamps only, no overhead.
- ☐ **Day 30:** Stand back. Note the one room that feels calmest and why — that's your template.

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*Keep the boxed-away pieces stored. After a month you'll keep most of them out of sight for good — and that, more than anything you add, is what makes a home read calm.*

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*"Styling isn't adding the right things. It's removing until only  
the right things are left — then lighting them warmly."*

KEEP GOING

The print collection · [calmandoak.com/shop/prints](https://calmandoak.com/shop/prints)

The free palette generator · [calmandoak.com/palette](https://calmandoak.com/palette)

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